# The Princess Saves Herself in This One

## By Amanda Lovelace

**(Pg 5)** ah, life-
the thing that happens to us
while we're off somewhere else
blowing on dandelions

& wishing ourselves into the pages
of our favorite fairy tales.

**(Pg 1)** warning: this is not a fairy tale.
there is no princess.
there is no damsel.
there is no queen.
there is no tower.
there are no dragons.
there is simply a girl
faced with the difficult task
of learning to believe in
herself.

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## INTRODUCTION

*But this collection of poetry **is** a story of rising from the ashes of abuse – of surviving. The fact is, a knight in shining armor may never arrive to save you . . . you may be the one who has to save yourself.*

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**(Pg 11)** ~~the queen~~
my mother smiled
as she offered
a cube of
sugar
in her upturned palm.
greedily,
i accepted.
i reached inside my mouth,
delicately placing one (just one)
on the center of my tongue, & i clamped down.
salt.
that is what abuse is: knowing you are going to
get salt
but still hoping for sugar for nineteen years.

***- you may be gone, but i still have a stomachache.***

**(Pg 15)** there are
some mothers who will warn you
to never ever
*(ever ever)*
touch the stove,
but there are
some mothers who
will drag you right to it
kicking & screaming, laughing
as they
watch the flames lick at your fingertips.

***- when you're taught to see the world through fire, nothing looks safe.***

**(Pg 10)** the little girl
isn't listening to you-
she's way too busy staring out the window,
fantasizing about
a world of
magical accidents, flying envelopes,
screeching owls, adoring giants,
brooms that
do more than sweep,
friends who are always loyal,
& a train
that will take her

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to an enchanted place far far far
away from
here.

***- put under a lifelong spell.***

**(Pg 34)** birds can't
fly away when you
clip
one of
their wings.
you
weren't satisfied with just clipping one of
my wings.
you tore both
out from the root
to make sure i could
never fly anywhere
ever
again.

***- mother & daughter.***

**(Pg 186)** just because they don't hit you
doesn't mean it isn't
abuse.
wouldn't you think it
a crime
to look up at

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the night sky & tell
the stars
that they have no sparkle?
guess what? you shine brighter
than all the starlight
there has
ever been
or ever
will be.

***- emotional abuse is still abuse.***

**(Pg 41)** you may
not have left (many) bruises on my skin,
but you left giant blackberry bruises all over
my soul.

***- i still wonder who i would have been.***

**(Pg 154)** i hope you
can find it in your heart
to be proud
of the woman
i have become in spite
of
you.

***- still hoping for sugar instead of salt.***

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## TRANSITION

*And yet, despite everything; we will always yearn for the love of our mothers. Time heals all wounds, right? Wrong. Sometimes, time is stolen from us and there is no time to heal those relationships. Then what do you do? What do you do if you are only 19 and your mother, no matter how horrible she was, is no longer there?*

**(Pg 65)** you will think
your parents are
**shatterproof** until one day
you find out
**t h e y  a r e n ' t.**

***- what it really means to lose your innocence.***

**(Pg 62)** my
mom
told the nice doctor
she was seeing starbursts
in her eyes
& they were almost beautiful
to her-
like the
fourth of
july
had decided to come early.
the doctor hesitated before

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breaking the news to her.
"those aren't stars.
it's cancer."

***- forty years a smoker.***

**(Pg 64)** when your mother begins to forget your
name,
you begin
to wonder
if you exist
at all.

***- stage 4, terminal.***

**(Pg 88)** an image: a girl
with bruises underneath her eyes
from sleeping too much or too little.
a girl
with a
brokenhearted cat permanently
cradled in her
arms.
a girl
ignoring the piles of treasured books
surrounding
all sides
of her.
a girl
unable to bring herself to cry because if she

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finally cries then that means
it really happened.
is
there
such a
thing
as
dead mother's day?

**(Pg 78)** i was the one
who found your body
(*you* were nowhere
to be found),
mouth opened
wide enough
to suck all the oxygen from the room,
wide enough
to plant lilies in,
wide enough to have been calling my name-
that is, if only you remembered it.

***- i want to forget, forget, forget.***

**(Pg 102)** i am
caught between mourning
you
&
thinking

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your death saved
me.

***- will you ever be able to forgive me?***

**(Pg 96)** f*** the idea that there is such a thing
as destiny,
that there exists
some kind of mysterious master plan, that there
is a god who simply
does not
give us anything we cannot handle.
the pain
did not
make me
a better person. it did not
teach me not to take anything for granted.
it did not
teach me anything except how
to be afraid
to love anyone.
1 am
far too
young
to be so broken
&
if i could go back in time
& give

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myself
her childhood back,
i would.

***- what was the point?***

**(Pg 103)** the princess jumped from the tower
& she learned
that she could fly
all along.

***- she never needed those wings.***

**(Pg 1)** this is not a fairy tale.
there is no princess.
there is no damsel.
there is no queen.
there is no tower.
there are no dragons.
there is simply a girl
faced with the difficult task
of learning to believe in
herself.

**(Pg 182)** repeat after me: you owe
no one
your forgiveness.

***- except maybe yourself.***

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**(Pg 153)** i am
A lioness
who is no longer
afraid to let the world
hear her roar.

## SOURCE INFORMATION

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